

Progressive & Preterite Coda Survey (B12)

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Progressive (-ing) & Preterite (-ed) Coda Survey — Battery B12

Status: working analysis / draft. Feeds phonology.md (morphophonology) and verbal-system.md §4.2 (concord shapes). Predictions here are **hypotheses for elicitation**, not committed rules — the §3.22 finding is [Open]. **Date:** 2026-06-22. **Scope:** every verb lemma in dictionary.md plus the SAYING-round verbs (triage §4 D4-A), sorted by **conlang surface coda**, with the GA source coda alongside and a predicted -ing / -ed reflex for each class.

1. The two increments

Two pieces of inflectional morphology are at issue. Both are **concord shapes** in the sense of verbal-system.md §4.2 — endings the main verb carries in concord with its frame — and both are diachronic reflexes of GA verbal suffixes.

PROG — the progressive-shaped concord. Reflex of GA *-ing* /-ɪŋ/ → /-m/ (the colloquial *-in'* pronunciation; cf. the *-in* of placeholder *relaxin*, §4.2). Synchronically it behaves as a **nasal increment** that docks onto the stem coda. It is the *shape* exemplified by *beussno*, *rheinn*, *rhiimm*, *rhikriutm*, *bekrrũ* (§3.22) and by attested *splitm* “leaving.”

PRET — the preterite / perfect / passive concord (the “-ed” family). Reflex of GA *-ed* /-d ~ -t/ and the strong preterite, surfacing as a **coronal-stop increment** /-T/: plain *-t* (*pauiist*), geminate *-tt*, glottal *-ʔ* in isolation, or *-tm* when further suffixes follow (*biltm-ə-ay-et*). The regular exponent is the *-t(t)*- infix of §4.2.1; irregulars (strong verbs) keep GA morphology (*meiktt* → concord *meirtt*).

The unifying observation. Both increments routinely **resurrect an etymological coda that the regular sound-change cascade deleted or altered**. GA codas that vanish word-finally (*recruit* /t/ → *rhikriu*, *click* /k/ → *kli*) or mutate (*drive* /v/ → *rhiib* /b/, *bicker* /r/ → *bekw* /w/) reappear under inflection (*rhikriutm*, *rhiimm*, *bekrrũ*). The inflected stem is partly a **diachronic fossil**: the suffix re-exposes the underlying form. This is why coda shape is so strongly predictive — and why the bare lemma sometimes *under-*determines the inflected form (two lemmas that fell together in the citation form can split again under -ing; see §4, Class V).

A second principle, already on record: **coda material resurfaces intervocalically under vowel-initial concord** (verbal-system.md §4.2.2, *bemmorret* ~ *bemmorreut*; the rhotic of GA *remember* returns between vowels). PROG and PRET both trigger this.

2. Attested data (the anchor set)

Everything below is predicted *from* these. PROG forms unless marked.

Lemma	GA source	GA coda	Conlang coda (lemma)	Inflected	Pattern
<i>rheĩ</i>	<i>rain</i>	/n/	nasal vowel /ĩ/	<i>rheinn</i>	nasal geminate → /-ĩn:/
<i>beusso</i>	<i>pass out</i>	/t/ (→∅)	oral vowel /o:/	<i>beussno</i>	nasal infix before final V → /-no:/
<i>rhiib</i>	<i>drive</i>	/v/	voiced stop /b/	<i>rhiimm</i>	stop nasalizes → geminate /-m:/
<i>rhikriu</i>	<i>recruit</i>	/t/ (→∅)	oral vowel /iu/	<i>rhikriutm</i>	GA stop resurfaces + syllabic nasal → /-tm/
<i>bekw</i>	<i>bicker</i>	/r/	syllabic /w/	<i>bekrũ</i>	linking-r returns + nasal vowel → /-rĩ/
<i>split</i>	<i>split</i>	/t/	voiceless stop /t/	<i>splitm</i>	stop + syllabic nasal → /-tm/
<i>pauiis</i>	<i>apologize</i>	/z/ (→/s/)	/s/	<i>pauiist</i> (PRET)	/s/ + t → /-st/
<i>pilnn</i>	<i>fill in</i>	/n/	syll. geminate nasal /n:/	<i>piltm...</i> (PRET)	glottal-t under agglutination → /-tm/
<i>bemmw</i>	<i>remember</i>	/r/	syllabic /w/	<i>bemmorret</i> (PRET)	rhotic resurfaces intervocalically + t → /-orret/
<i>meiktt</i>	<i>make it</i>	/t/	glottal /kʔ/	<i>meirtt</i> (PRET, irreg.)	strong-verb morphology retained

The constant in the PROG column is a **nasal**; what differs is how the host coda forces it to surface. The constant in the PRET column is a **coronal stop** /T/.

3. How to read the coda columns

- **GA coda** = the consonant(s) closing the source word (or the source *phrase*'s final word, for fused phrasals like *pass out*, *pick up*). “(→∅)” marks a GA coda that the cascade deletes word-finally; “(→X)” a coda that

mutates.

- **Conlang coda** = the surface coda of the citation form, from the dictionary IPA.
- Classes are ordered roughly by how much the coda *resists* vs. *hosts* the nasal increment.

4. Verbs by conlang coda shape, with predictions

Class V — oral vowel-final

Members: *o* (go), *ospü* (speak), *eppli* (apply), *kli* (click), *spyi* (spew), *piquô* (pick out), *piquôä* (peek over at), *rhiitsô* (reach out), *rhiinyü* (really need), *rhiysseunnou* (really stand out), *rékriiyä* (yakitty-yak), *noë* (annoy), *beusso/beussou* (pass out), *rhikriu* (recruit), *reuto* (get it).

This is the largest and **least uniform** class, because a surface vowel-final lemma hides one of two histories:

- **(a) Genuinely vowel-final in GA** (*apply* /aɪ/, *spew* /u:/, *annoy* /ɔɪ/): nothing to resurrect. **PROG predicted:** nasal infixes / appends before or onto the final vowel, on the *beussno* model. *eppli* → *epplinni*; *spyi* → *spinni* ~ *spyinni*; *noë* → *noenn*. **PRET predicted:** bare /-t/ on the vowel — *eppliit*, *noët*.
- **(b) Vowel-final only by GA-coda deletion** (*recruit* /t/, *click* /k/, *speak* /k/, *pick out* /t/, *reach out* /t/, *get it* /t/): the suppressed GA stop resurfaces under inflection, exactly as in *rhikriutm*. **PROG predicted:** /-Tɱ/ — *kli* → *klikm*, *ospü* → *ospikm*, *piquô* → *piquotm*, *rhiitsô* → *rhiitsotm*. **PRET predicted:** the stop + /t/ (or a geminate) — *kli* → *klikt*, *ospü* → *ospikt*.

This is the single most important prediction of the survey: for Class V, the *citation form does not tell you the inflected form*. The author should elicit -ing on a vowel-final lemma of *known* GA-stop origin (*click*, *speak*) to confirm the resurrection pattern, and on a true-vowel-final lemma (*apply*, *spew*) to confirm the bare-nasal-infix pattern. If both hold, PROG/PRET become a **diagnostic for the etymological coda** — a clean internal-reconstruction tool.

Class Ṽ — nasal-vowel-final

Members: *rheĩ* (rain), *rhũ* (ring), *q* (own), *bényq* (opinion), *baurzũ* (barge in). **Source codas:** GA /n/, /ŋ/ — nasality already lives on the vowel. **PROG (attested on *rheĩ*→*rheinn*):** the latent nasal geminates / surfaces as a coda nasal → /-Ńn/. *rhũ* → *rhũnn*; *q* → *onn*; *bényq* → *bényonn*; *baurzũ* → *baurzũnn*. **PRET predicted:** nasal vowel + /t/ → /-Ńt/ — *rheĩ* → *rheĩt*, *q* → *qt*. (Possible nasal-t cluster /-nt/ if the nasal hardens; elicit.)

Class Db — voiced-stop-final (all surface /b/)

Members: *rhiib* (drive, GA /v/), *rib* (give, GA /v/), *preb* (prep, GA /p/). **PROG (attested on *rhiib*→*rhiimm*):** the stop assimilates to a homorganic nasal geminate → labial /b/ → /m/. *rib* → *rimm*; *preb* → *premm*. (Predicted general rule: /b d g/ → /m/; n: ŋ:/ under PROG; only labials attested so far.) **PRET predicted:** stop devoices and clusters with /t/ → /-pt/ — *rhiib* → *rhiipt*, *rib* → *ript*, *preb* → *prept*. Whether it is /-pt/ or a glottalized geminate /-pp/ is open.

Class Tp — voiceless-stop-final

Members: *split* (*split*, /t/), *pot* (*pout*, /t/), *reut* (*get it*, /t/), *réryt* (*narrate*, /t/), *bęiink* (*panic*, /k/). **PROG (attested on *split*→*splitm*):** stop + syllabic nasal → /-Tɱ/ (identical surface result to the Class-V(b) resurrection, since the stop is already present). *pot* → *potm*; *reut* → *reutm*; *réryt* → *rérytm*; *bęiink* → *bęiinkm*. **PRET predicted:** the coda already is a coronal stop, so PRET should show **gemination or glottalization rather than an added segment** — *split* → *splitt* ~ *spli?*, *pot* → *pott*. For the velar *bęiink*, a true added /t/ → *bęiinkt*.

Class Glt — glottal-stop-final

Members: *nott* (note, /t/), *meiktt* (make it, /t/ → /kʔ/). **Note:** these are Class-Tp stops already weakened to /ʔ/ (E2a). The lemma's glottal is an eroded coronal. **PROG predicted:** glottal restitutes to a stop + syllabic nasal → *nott* → *notm*, *meiktt* → *meiktm*. **PRET:** for *nott* the glottal already encodes the historical /-t/, so PRET is likely **vacuous in isolation** (*nott*) and only re-exposes /t/ under agglutination (cf. *piltm*). *meiktt* is **irregular** → *meirtt* (§4.2.1).

Class S — /s/-final (incl. geminate /s:/)

Members: *nous* (notice), *rhemmés* (reminisce), *pauyiis* (apologize); geminates *baurráuss* (process), *beáumss* (promise), and the cluster *pokss* (focus, /ks:/). **PRET (attested on *pauyiis*→*pauyiist*):** /s/ + t → /-st/. *nous* → *noušt*; *rhemmés* → *rhemmêšt*; *baurráuss* → *baurráusst*; *beáumss* → *beáumsst*. **PROG predicted:** a sibilant blocks nasal assimilation, so the nasal should surface **syllabic** → /-sɲ/. *nous* → *noušn*; *rhemmés* → *rhemmêšn*; *pauyiis* → *pauyiisn*. (Alternatively a buffer vowel: /-sən/. Elicit.)

Class Sh — /ʃ/-final

Members: *réush* (cherish), *rhiiyshêush* (really cherish). **PROG predicted:** syllabic nasal, as Class S → *réushn*. **PRET predicted:** /ʃ/ + t → /-ʃt/ → *réusht*, *rhiiyshêusht*.

Class W — syllabic /w/ appendix (vocalized GA -er / -le)

Members: from GA -er: *bemmw* (remember), *bekw* (bicker), *rhinnw* (wonder), *baunnw* (ponder); from GA -le: *barnkw* (barnacle), *toutw* (total to); other: *réquôpw* (check off). This class behaves specially because the /w/ is a **vocalized rhotic or lateral**, and inflection brings the original liquid back (the §4.2.2 resurfacing). **PROG (attested on *bekw*→*bekrrũ*; -er source):** linking-r returns + nasal vowel → /-rĩ/. *bemmw* → *bemrrũ*; *rhinnw* → *rhinrrũ*; *baunnw* → *baunrrũ*. **PRET (attested on *bemmw*→*bemmorret*; -er source):** rhotic resurfaces **intervocally** + /t/ → /-orret/. *bekw* → *bekorret*; *rhinnw* → *rhinorret*. **Open — the -le subclass.** *barnacle/total* gave /w/ from a **lateral**, not a rhotic. Does the lateral come back (*barnkw* → *barnklĩ*?), or does it merge into the -er pattern (rhotacized *barnkrũ*)? **No data — elicit a -le verb directly** (suggestions in §5).

Class N — syllabic geminate nasal

Member: *pilnn* (fill in). **PROG predicted:** already maximally nasal; the increment should be **absorbed** (length/no change) — *pilnn*. **PRET (attested, agglutinating):** glottal-t → /-tm/ before further suffixes (*piltm·ē·ay·et*).

Class App / Clu — stop appendix & complex clusters

Members: *pikkp* (pick up, /-p/), *bessts* (message, /s:ts/), *rhiišp* (worship, /ʃp/), *ospokwɸ* (speak with, /kwθ/). Heavy edge cases; the increment is forced syllabic. **PROG:** *pikkp* → *pikkpm*; *rhiišp* → *rhiišpm*. **PRET:** *pikkp* → *pikkpt*; cluster behavior otherwise open. Flag for individual treatment, not a general rule.

5. Coda shapes that are missing or thin — and verbs to fill them

Two kinds of gap. **Principled gaps** (the cascade actively bans the shape) and **survey holes** (the shape is licit but unattested for verbs). Suggested test verbs give the GA form and the prediction the elicitation would check.

Principled gaps (confirm the ban, don't expect the coda)

- **Voiced-fricative codas** /z v ð/ — *none*, and apparently by rule: GA /z/ devoices (*apologize* → *pauiis* /s/) and GA /v/ stops (*drive, give* → /b/). **Test:** *use* /ju:z/, *please* /pli:z/, *breathe* /bri:ð/. Prediction: /-s/ (and a Class-S inflection) or /-b/. If any voiced fricative *survives*, that's a real finding for phonology.md §4.4.
- **Lateral /l/ coda** — *none*; GA dark /ɫ/ vocalizes everywhere (§4.4.4). Not a verb-specific hole.

Survey holes (licit codas, no verb yet) — recommended elicitation set

1. **Rhotic coda** /r/ (from back-vowel dark-l, §4.4.4 → /ɹ/ → /r/): GA *pull* /pʊɫ/, *call* /kɔɫ/. Prediction: *pull* → /pʊr/ with a **surface tap coda** — the only route to a non-vocalized rhotic. Tests whether PROG rhotacizes further or nasalizes (*purm?* *purru?*).
2. **Glide** /j/ **coda** (from front-vowel dark-l, §4.4.4): GA *feel* /fi:ɫ/, *deal*, *heal*. Prediction: /-ij/ coda. Tests PROG on a glide (geminate -iyy? nasal infix -ijn?).
3. **Consonantal nasal coda** /m n/ (vs. the Class-Ũ nasal-vowel outcome): GA *seem* /si:m/, *blame* /bleim/, *learn* /lɜ:n/. Prediction: does the nasal stay a **coda consonant** or colour the vowel (→ Class Ũ)? This directly tests the boundary of Class Ũ.
4. **Affricate coda** /tʃ dʒ/: GA *teach* /ti:tʃ/, *watch* /watʃ/, *judge* /dʒʌdʒ/. Prediction: /tʃ/ → /ts/ (cf. *reach out* → *rhiitsô* medially) giving a /-ts/ **coda**; PROG then like Class Tp (-tsm?).
5. **Bare voiceless non-sibilant fricative** /f θ/: GA *laugh* /læf/, *cough* /kɔf/, *bathe* → *breath* /θ/. Prediction: survives as /-f/, /-θ/ (cf. *ospokwɔ*, *réquôpw* where /θ/ persists in cluster); PROG syllabic (-fm, -θm) like Class S.
6. **Velar nasal** /ŋ/ — **confirm the merger**. GA -ing-stem or *bang, hang*. Prediction: → nasal vowel (Class Ũ), as *ring* → *rhiũ*. Likely already resolved; one datapoint would close it.

A compact elicitation battery, then, is: **pull, feel, seem, teach, laugh, use** (six verbs) — one per hole, each chosen so its GA coda is unambiguous.

6. Summary of predicted morphophonology

Conlang coda class	PROG (-ing, nasal /-N/)	PRET (-ed, coronal /-T/)	Status
Ũ nasal-vowel	nasal geminates /-Ũn:/	/-Ũt/	PROG attested
V — true vowel	nasal infix /-nV/	/-Vt/	PROG attested (<i>beussno</i>)
V — masks GA stop	stop resurfaces + /-m/ → /-Tm/	stop + /t/	PROG attested (<i>rhikriutm</i>)
Db voiced stop	nasalizes → geminate nasal /-N:/	devoice + /t/ → /-pt/	PROG attested (<i>rhiimm</i>)
Tp voiceless stop	/-Tm/ syllabic nasal	geminate/glottal /-tt ~ ?/	PROG attested (<i>splitm</i>)
Glt glottal	restitute stop + /-m/	vacuous / agglutinating /-tm/	predicted
S sibilant /s s:/	syllabic /-sn/	/-st/	PRET attested (<i>pauiist</i>)
Sh /ʃ/	syllabic /-fɲ/	/-ft/	predicted
W /w/ (-er)	linking-r + nasal V /-rĩ/	rhotic + /t/ /-orret/	both attested
W /w/ (-le)	? lateral return vs. rhotacism	?	gap — elicit
N syll. nasal	absorbed (no change)	agglutinating /-tm/	PRET attested (<i>piltm</i>)
App / Clu	syllabic /-m/	+ /t/	per-item, open

Two rules worth proposing to phonology,md once confirmed: 1. **PROG** = a nasal mora that (i) geminates a nasal coda, (ii) nasalizes a voiced stop, (iii) surfaces as a syllabic nasal after a voiceless stop or sibilant, (iv) infixes before a final vowel, and (v) triggers liquid-resurrection in the /w/ class. The single morpheme, five contextual reflexes. 2. **Inflection re-exposes etymological codas** deleted word-finally by the cascade — making PROG/PRET a synchronic window onto the GA source coda (the “fossil” effect).

7. Open questions

- **Class V split** — does -ing reliably distinguish true-vowel-final from stop-masking lemmas? (The whole “fossil” claim rests on this. Highest-value elicitation.)
- **Db beyond labials** — confirm /d g/ → /n: ŋ:/ under PROG with a non-labial voiced-stop verb.
- **Sibilant PROG** — syllabic /-sŋ/ vs. buffered /-sən/.
- **-le subclass of W** — lateral return or merger into the rhotic pattern.
- **PRET on stop-final stems** — added /t/, gemination, or glottalization.
- These all sit under §3.22 / battery **B12**, [**Open**].